Har khet Swasth Khet

After green revolution, indiscriminate use of nitrogenous fertilizers, less use of organic fertilizer and increased cropping intensity has resulted into impaired soil health. Multi elemental deficiencies anddeteriorated soil physical conditions have halted the increase in crop productivity. Also, these Multi elemental deficiencies have impacted human and animal health. To identify and quantify soil health deterioration factors, soil testing is needed.

What is Soil Testing

Since six decades, importance of soil testing has been given importance in agriculture and its use has become widely accepted.Soil testing is referred as the analysis of soils samples fordetermining physico-chemical properties of the soils like electrical conductivity, pH andsoil fertility parameters viz phosphorus, potassium sulphur and micronutrients. It is essential for makingfertilizer application decision for sustainable crop production, reclamation of problematic soils and monitoring& maintenance of soil health. It is a rapid and accurate method for determining the deficiency of nutrients, if this deficiency is mitigated, higher yields are assured. Soil testing results provide information about type and amount of fertilizers to be applied in a particular crop for obtaining optimum crop yield. Thus, it increases farmer income by reducing input cost and increasing crop yield.

Objectives

1. To determine the fertility parameters for designing an effective nutrient management system
2. To provide an available nutrient status and physico-chemical properties of soil.
3. To study the nutrient dynamics due to cultivation over a period of years.
4. To generate digital soil fertility maps for delineating nutrient deficiencies/ sufficienciesareas.

5. To provide Lime & Gypsum requirement for problematic soils
6. To provide Soil Health Cards to farmers
7. It helps in development of integrated nutrient management models
8. To help policy makers in determining nutrient requirement for deficient areas.

Soil testing Network of Haryana

Haryana state has a wide network of soil testing where farmers has easy access for soil testing. There are three types of soil testing laboratories – Static soil testing laboratories-Atomic Atomic Absorption Spectrometer (AAS) based, Static soil testing laboratories- Inductively couple plasma spectrometer (ICP) based and mini-soil testing laboratories.Currently,there are 42 Static Soil Testing Laboratories are operational, 38 of which are AAS based and 4 are ICP based. At the end of year 2020-21, 10 more ICP based laboratories will be inducted. Thirty four mini STLs are in operation and their number will be 59 at the end of current financial year. Also, department has established 115 mini STLs in School/ colleges to promote “Earn while, You Learn.”

“HarKhetSwasthKhet” Abhiyan

Hon’able Chief Minister, Haryana has announced the “Soil Health Card for every acre of Agricultural Land” where each acre of agricultural land of the state is being sampled, tested. About 75 lakh soil samples will be collected and tested in three years i.e 2021-22, 2022-23 and 2023-24. Soil Health Cards (SHC) for every acre will be distributed to farmers in these three years. To achieve this target, the 140 blocks of each district will be distributed in three groups, one group consist of two or three blocks of each district. One group will be selected each year and soil sample will be taken from every acre of agricultural land. In 2021-22, 49 blocks are selected for this scheme whereas, in2022-23 and 2023-24, 49 and 42 will be undertaken.